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brand manifest

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Hej – the Scandinavian hello. Casual, warm, the sound of a door opening. In Denmark and Sweden it is not a formal greeting. It is what you say to someone you already like.

Kōhī – the Japanese word for coffee, コーヒー, carried into the language from Dutch traders in the 18th century, reshaped by Japanese mouths until it became something new. A borrowed word that forgot it was borrowed.

Two cultures with no obvious reason to share a table. And yet they do – in their love of craft, their respect for slowness, their belief that a small thing done with full attention is worth more than a large thing done carelessly.

The Scandinavian fika is not really about coffee. It is about pausing. The Japanese coffee ritual is not really about efficiency. It is about presence.

hejkōhī sits at that intersection.

We are not trying to be Nordic. We are not trying to be Japanese. We are trying to be what happens when those two ways of thinking about a cup of coffee meet in the same room – and find they already agree on the things that matter.

Come as you are. Stay as long as you like. The coffee is good.

the logo

The **hejkōhī** logo is carved by hand from a single piece of wood. Not printed. Not vectorised. Not generated. Carved – with a knife, slowly, once.

The block is inked and pressed to leave a mark that is slightly different every time. The grain of the wood is in there. The pressure of the hand is in there. No two impressions are identical. That is not a flaw in the process. *That is the process.*

We chose this method because it is honest. Wood is a material with a history – it grew somewhere, it took time, it has a direction. Carving it requires you to work with that, not against it. The result carries all of that in a way a file on a server never could.

The tradition of the carved wooden stamp runs through both cultures at the heart of this brand.

In Japan, the **hanko** – a personal seal

carved from wood or stone – has been used for centuries as a mark of identity and intention. In Scandinavia, wood carving is one of the oldest craft forms, a winter practice, patient and unhurried.

Our logo inherits both of those things.

When you see the mark on a cup or a bag or a piece of paper, you are looking at something made by hand, from a material that was once alive, pressed into the surface by a person who meant it.

the typeface

Aa 01

We set our text in Cormorant Garamond, designed by Johann Christian Miedl, a German-born type designer based in Vienna, and released as a free, open-source typeface in 2015. It is a contemporary revival of the work of Claude Garamond – a 16th century Parisian punchcutter whose letterforms have influenced Western typography for five hundred years.

We chose it because it carries warmth without ornamentation. The contrast between its thick and thin strokes feels drawn by hand rather than constructed by machine – which is exactly the spirit of hejkōhī. It also handles the macrons in hejkōhī with uncommon grace, letting the ō and ī sit as they should: quietly, precisely, meaningfully.

must haves



Raised tatami area – elevated platform, no shoes allowed, traditional seating

Noren – split fabric curtain in the doorway. Hanging = open, taken down = closed. Custom designed with the hejkōhī mark.

Japanese toilets – proper Toto-style, not decorative

mood board



the menu

Coffee

Flat white
Espresso
Slow filter brews

Tea

Matcha
Hojicha

Food

Kanelbullar – cinnamon buns
Kardemummabullar – cardamom buns
Onigiri
Banana bread

Water – always free

